

page for implementing the best practices identified in the review.

Common mistakes made when using AWS WAR

The AWS Well-Architected Review process is a systematic approach to evaluating AWS architectures and identifying potential issues. However, there are a few mistakes organisations may make when incorporating this process.

Lack of consistency and depth: One common mistake is not conducting the review in a consistent manner and failing to dive deep into the architecture. The review process should be consistent, with a blame-free approach that encourages thorough examination of the architecture.

Treating it as an audit: Another mistake is treating the review process as an audit rather than a conversation. It should be a lightweight process that fosters a conversation about the architecture, rather than an accusatory interrogation.

Neglecting design principles and pillars: Organisations may neglect the design principles and pillars outlined in the AWS well-architected framework. This can lead to overlooking critical areas that often feature in root cause analysis (RCA)

Infrequent reviews: Not conducting the Well-Architected Review regularly is a common mistake. AWS recommends conducting the review every 12-18 months to ensure that architectures are aligned with best practices, and to identify and fix potential issues.

Failure to incorporate improvement strategies: During the review process, it's important to look at improvement strategies. Organisations may make the mistake of not prioritising a plan for addressing identified issues and opportunities for improvement.

Inadequate use of well-architected tool: Organisations may not fully utilise the AWS well-architected tool, which is designed to evaluate cloud architecture against best practices, identify improvement opportunities, and track progress over time.

Lack of alignment with built-in AWS system review processes: The review process should align seamlessly with built-in AWS system review processes to ensure that the architecture remains effective and aligned with organisational goals.

Incorporating the AWS Well-Architected Review process effectively involves addressing these common mistakes to ensure that architectures are well-aligned with best practices and continuously improved over time.

Saving costs with AWS WAR

AWS Well-Architected Review can significantly save costs by identifying areas for optimisation and waste reduction in the following manner.

- **Rightsizing resources:** The review assesses your resource utilisation. It can uncover overprovisioned instances running 24/7 when they could be scaled down or stopped during non-peak hours.
- **Identifying unused resources:** You may have idle resources like EC2 instances left running in development environments over weekends. The review can pinpoint these and recommend strategies like stopping them or using spot instances for cost-effective utilisation.
- **Optimising instance types:** The review can identify instances with configurations exceeding your actual needs. You may be paying

for a powerful CPU when a memory-optimised instance would suffice for your workload, reducing costs.

- **Leveraging reserved instances and savings plans:** The review can analyse your predictable workloads and suggest using reserved instances or savings plans to secure significant discounts compared to on-demand pricing.
- **Uncovering inefficient services:** You may be using a more expensive service when a more cost-effective alternative exists for your specific use case. The review can identify these opportunities and suggest cost-optimised service options.

By implementing these recommendations from a Well-Architected Review, significant costs can be saved while maintaining the performance and efficiency of your cloud environment. Remember, the 'cost optimisation' pillar of the well-architected framework is all about finding the right balance between cost and performance for your specific needs.

Incorporating the AWS Well-Architected Review into the SDLC can significantly enhance the quality of cloud software deliverables. By providing a set of best practices and guiding principles, it helps developers design, test, and operate reliable, efficient, and cost-effective systems on AWS. Thus, it's an invaluable tool for any organisation seeking to optimise their use of the AWS cloud. **END** 

References

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